

OKSANA BIHUN

Composer | Vocalist | Poet

Moorhead, MN | obihun.phd@gmail.com

ARTISTIC FOCUS

Composer and vocalist creating original works for voice, piano, and choral ensembles, integrating poetry, music, and themes of spiritual experience and emotional transformation.

EDUCATION

Kos-Anatolsky Music School No. 1, Lviv, Ukraine, Distinction of Excellence 1986–1994
Piano, bandura (similar to the harp), solfeggio (music theory), choir, and music literature

COMPOSITIONS

- *Gentle Flower*, song cycle for voice and piano, 50 minutes, 2026
- *Summer Blooms*, a ballad for an SSA ensemble, a cappella, 3:45, 2026; performed by the women's ensemble Summer Blooms
- *Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom* for mixed choir, 60 minutes, 2024
- *Salve Regina* for mixed choir, 3 minutes, 2009; performed by Galician Chamber Choir "Yevshan"
- *The Avenues of Sound Run, Autumn Rode Across the Field, Evening Romance*, songs for voice and guitar, 7 minutes total, 2002, 2003, and 2018; performed by the composer
- *Ukraine, Wedding March, Ri-ri, Autumn, Evening Alone*, piano pieces, 23 minutes, 2008–2020; performed by the composer

PERFORMANCES

- Solo vocalist – *Gentle Flower*, song cycle for voice and piano; professionally engineered recording, 2026
- Soloist – Fargo-Moorhead Choral Artists, 2025
- Cantor – NDSU Newman Center, 2025–present; St. Joseph Church, 2011–2015
- Singer – Fargo-Moorhead Choral Artists, 2022–2025; Sacred Heart Choir, 2006–2009 and 2016–2019; Revelation Choir, 2011–2015 and 2020–2022; Galician Chamber Choir "Yevshan" (Ukraine, two CD recordings and a tour in Europe), 2001–2003
- Performer – bandura and piano in concerts and theatrical productions, 1990–2026

DIRECTING

- Artistic Director, Summer Blooms women's ensemble, 2025–present
- Curator, organizer, and performer in poetry and music concerts (voice, bandura, guitar, cello collaboration), 1994–2003, 2016–present
- Musical director for theatrical productions *Truth will Liberate Us*, *Three Loves*, *The Great Vault*, and others, by artistic group Osmoloda; two productions won first prizes in competitions at Ivan Franko National University of Lviv, 1996–2001

PUBLICATIONS

- *Divine Liturgy of St. John Chrysostom* for mixed choir, Public Choral Domain Library, 2025, and Kule Folklore Centre, University of Alberta, Canada, 2026
- *Underwork Yourself: How to Combine Self-care and Work*, a psychological self-help book that combines evidence-based material with fiction and poetry, Amazon, 2022
- *Distance to the Border. Labyrinth*, two-volume poetry collection, Spolom, 2018
- *Anticipation of Christmas*, poetry book, 100 pages, Kamenyar, 2010
- *Poetry* in collections, journals, and newspapers Pryvitannia Zhyttia, Arka, Kamenyar, and Dzvin

AWARDS AND MEMBERSHIPS

- Individual Artist Grant to perform and record the album *Gentle Flower, The Arts Partnership* (2026)
- First Prize, *Kateryna Mandryk-Kuybida Award* (2020)
- Recipient, *Panteleimon Kulish International Literature and Arts Award* (2019)
- Member, *National Society of Writers of Ukraine* (since 2019)
- Member, *International Academy of Literature and Arts*, Ukraine (since 2019)

SKILLS

Solo/choral singing and conducting; composition (choral, solo voice, piano, and guitar music); piano and bandura performance; poetry writing

BACKGROUND

Ph.D. in Mathematics, University of Missouri, Columbia, 2009; former mathematics professor at Concordia College and the University of Colorado (11 years); currently an AI trainer and math expert at Mercor, working part-time alongside an active artistic practice.